

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: August 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Before overheads, so this is not profit. Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

July 2026

Locked

July 2026 is locked (closed 4 Aug 2026). These numbers won't change.

August 2026

Locked

August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

August's jobs made \$73,637 gross margin (41.1%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$10,060 and overheads \$59,500, leaving \$4,077 profit before tax (2.3% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 38.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$73,637
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$44,540
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$10,060
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$63,577
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,500
Profit before tax (the P&L)	\$4,077
Revenue	\$179,007
Gross margin on jobs, %	41.1%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	2.3%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	38.9%

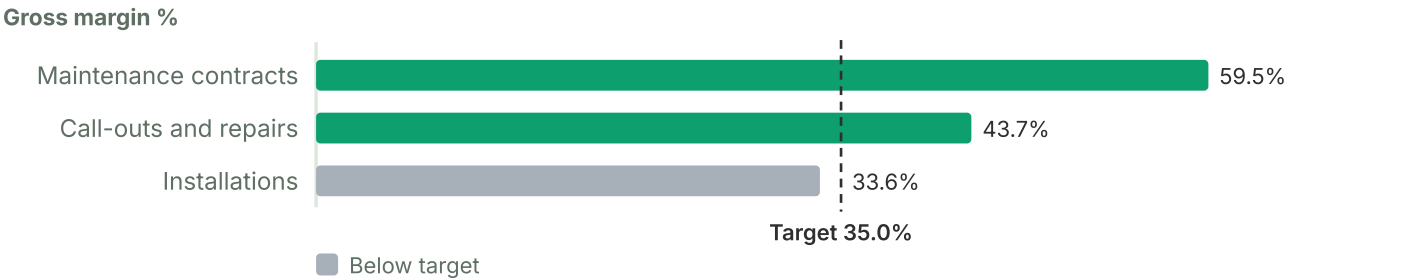
Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, August · All jobs

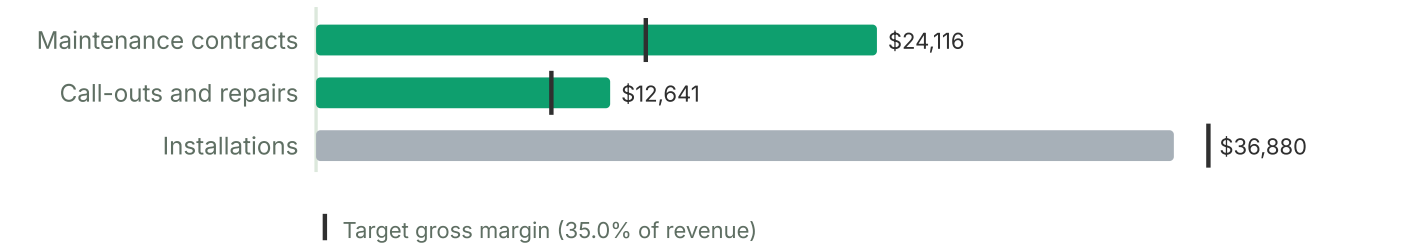
41.1%

July 36.8%

Job gross margin by type of job, August 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In August maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 33.6% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.7% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 38.9% just to cover overheads.

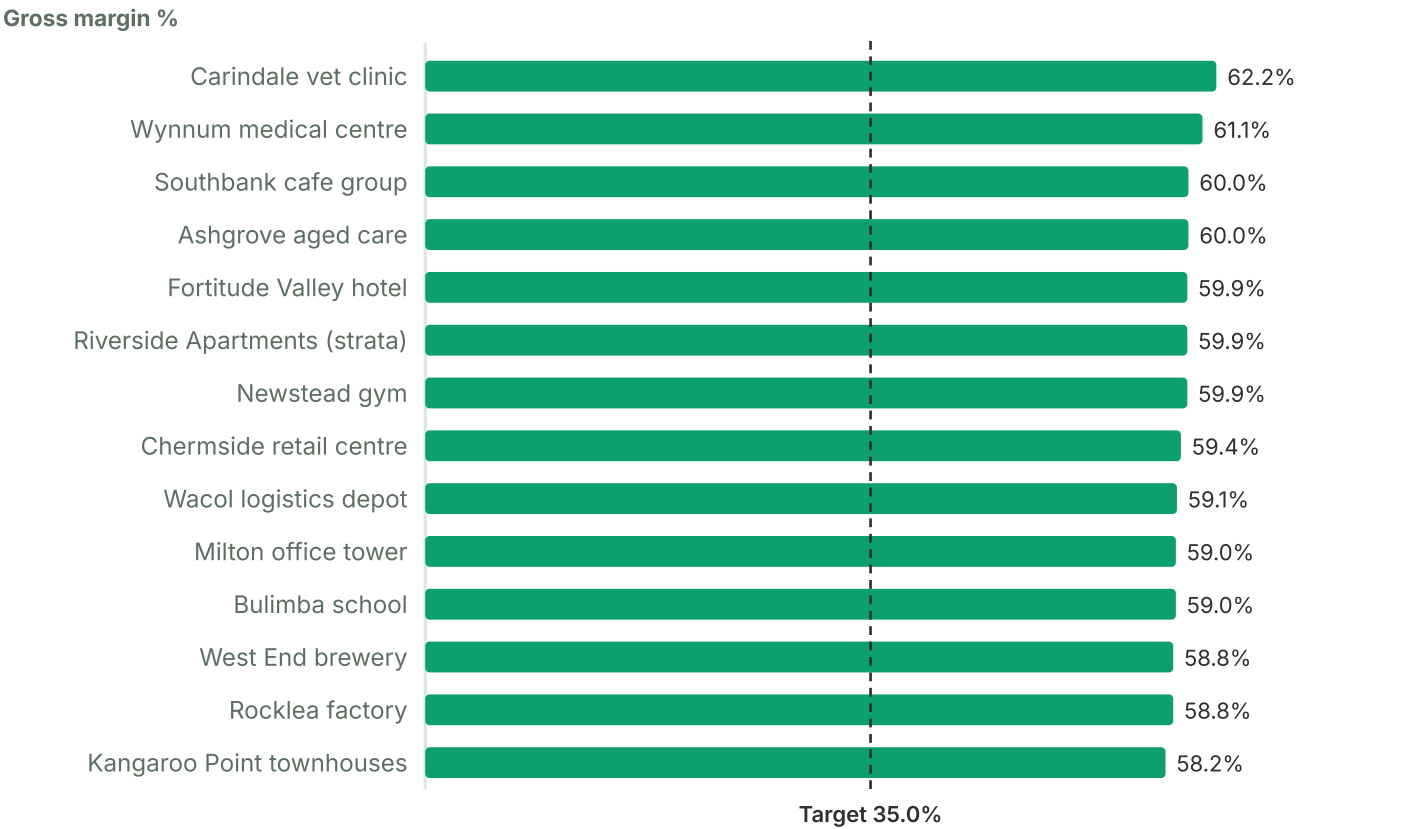
What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, the most profitable work you do. Installations: 33.6% gross margin, below the 38.9% needed to cover overheads.

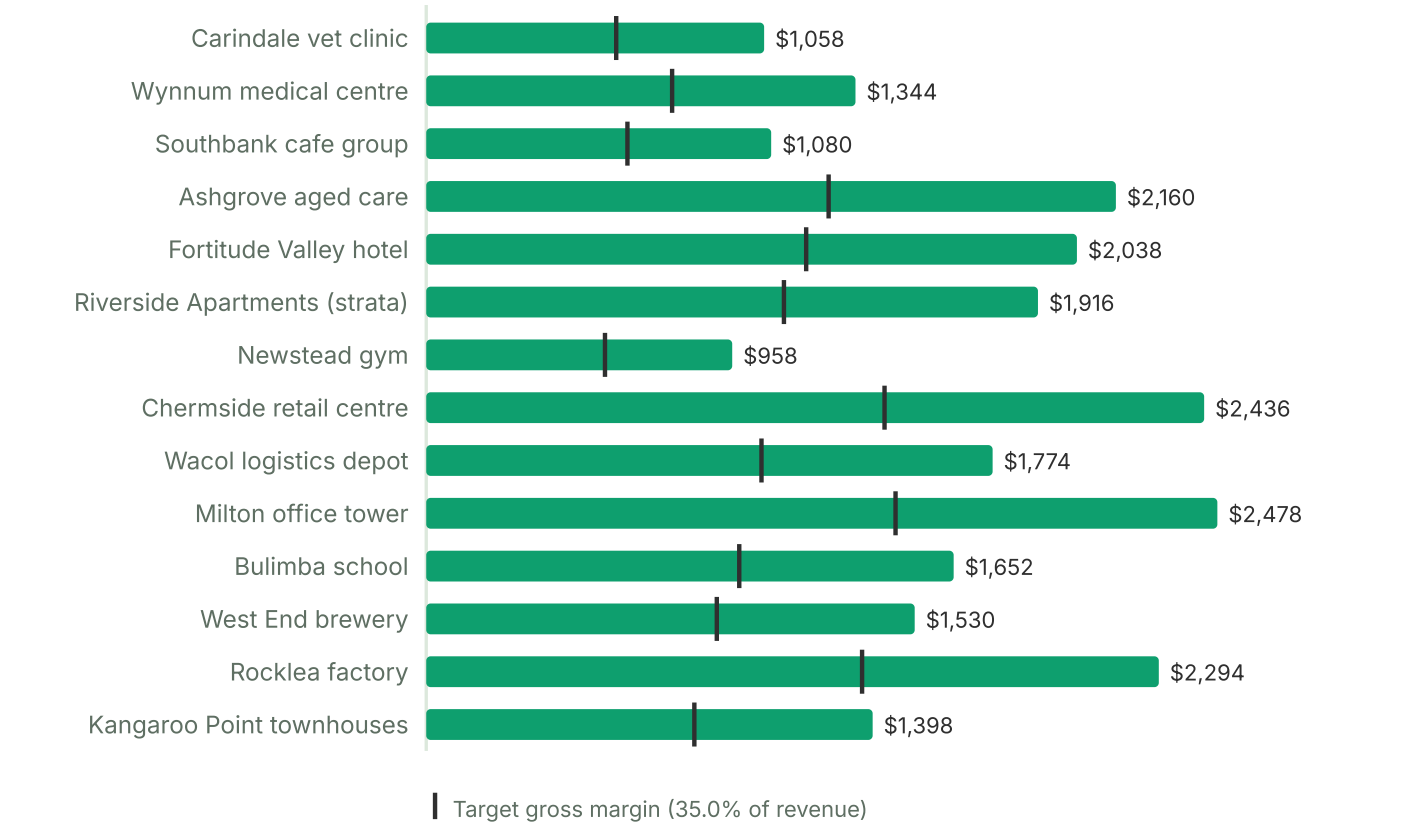
Type of job: Maintenance contracts



Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, August 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

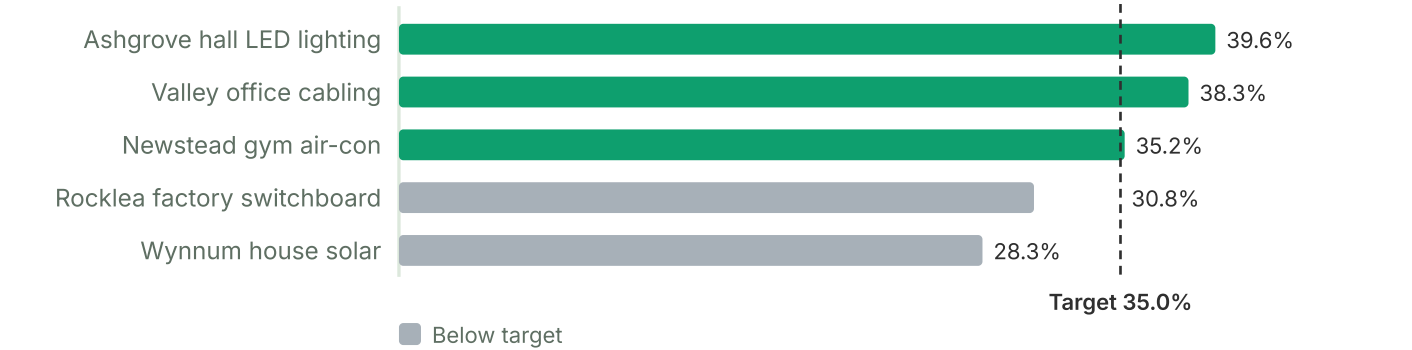
The Kangaroo Point townhouses contract: 58.2% gross margin, 19.4 points clear of the 38.9% overheads need. Maintenance contracts overall: 59.5% gross margin.

Type of job: Installations

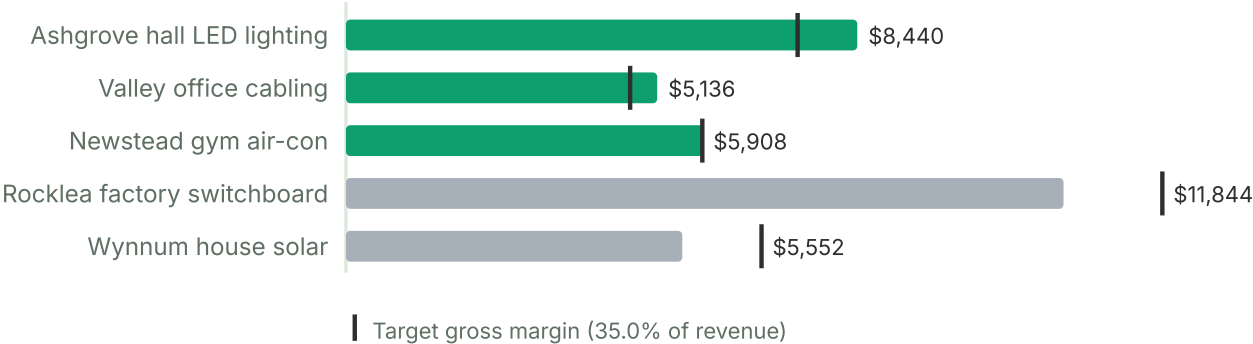


Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

2 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in August made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Wynnum house solar made a 28.3% job gross margin: 36.0 h of technician time (\$2,448) and \$2,200 of subcontractors on a \$19,600 job. Jobs need 38.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Below the 38.9% overheads need: Valley office cabling (38.3%), Newstead gym air-con (35.2%), Rocklea factory switchboard (30.8%), Wynnum house solar (28.3%). Most profitable: Ashgrove hall LED lighting (39.6%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, August · Call-outs and repairs

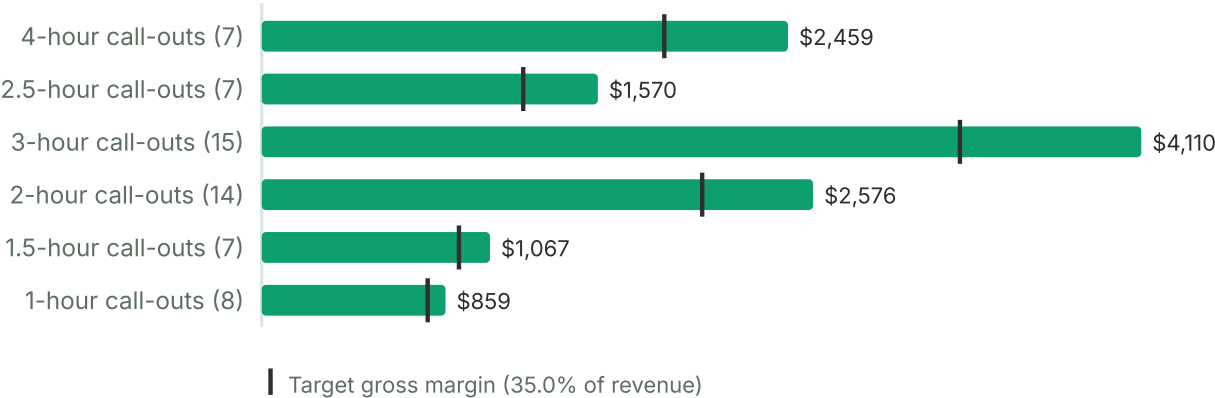
43.7%
July 43.4%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, August 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

58 call-outs in August made a 43.7% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 38.8% to 45.8% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

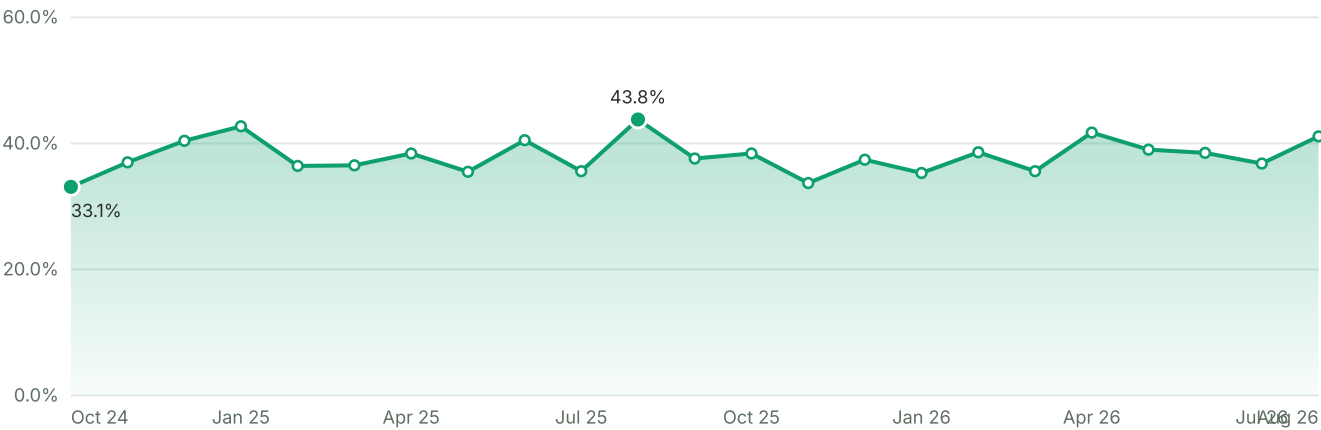
What you'd do about it

Call-outs: 43.7% gross margin, 4.9 points clear of the 38.9% overheads need.

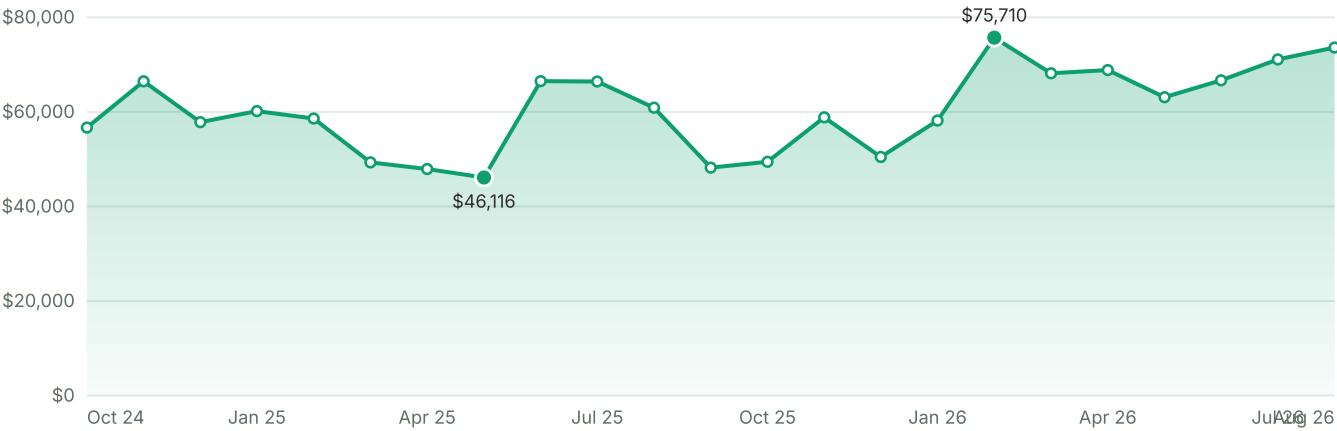
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.